Panic at the Terminal

SWE 4304: Software Project Lab I

Project Proposal

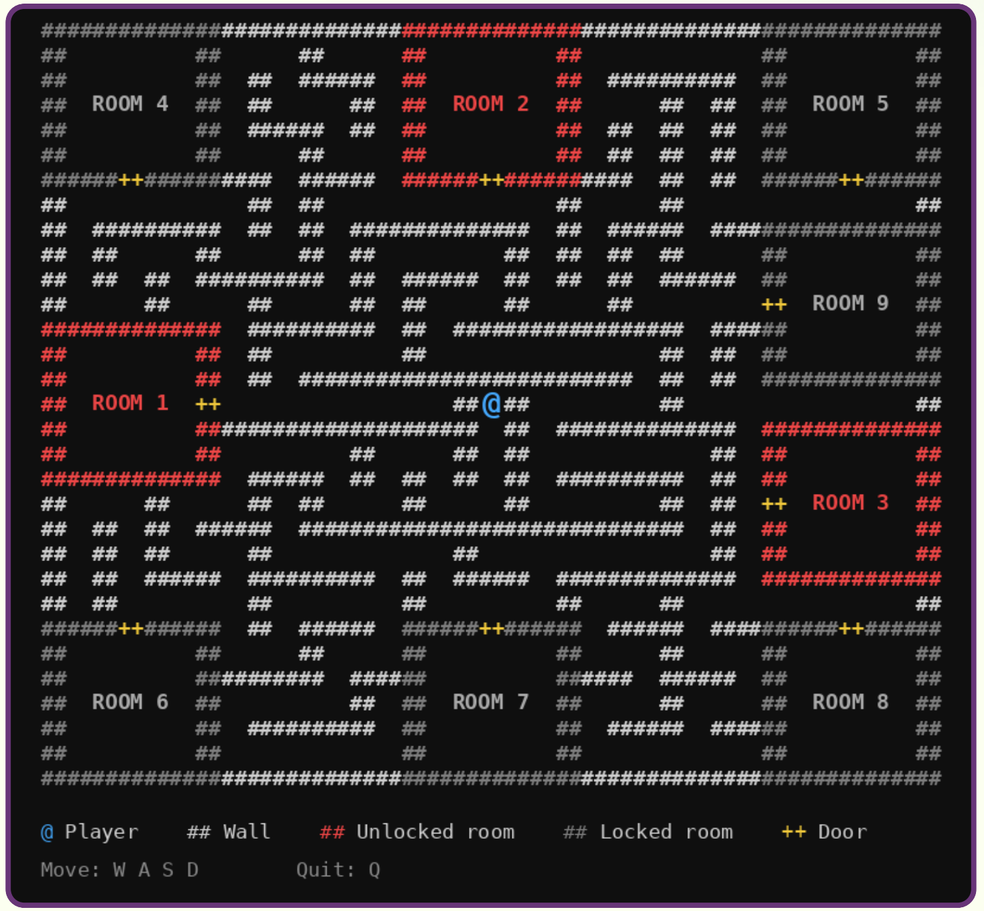
Group 13

Lamisa Ibnat Zaman	240042141
Nusrat Zahan Nishi	240042145
Mohsina Islam	240042146

November 11, 2026

Introduction

Panic At The Terminal is a CLI-based adventure game where players navigate a randomly generated maze, explore nine rooms, and complete minigames to collect jigsaw pieces and solve it.



Motivation

01 Terminal games are fun to play and just as fun to build.

02 Puzzles keep players engaged with a new challenge in every room.

03 A quick game is a simple cure for boredom.

04 Solving problems keeps the brain active and sharpens logic.

05 Leaderboards add friendly competition and a reason to replay.

Problem Statement

Repetitive gameplay

Most terminal games rely on one mechanic, so they feel repetitive after a few plays

Little Progression

Few offer locked areas, rewards or a clear goal that gives a session a start and an end

Not Thrilling Enough

Scores and progress are rarely tracked, so there is little reason to return and improve

How can a terminal game stay engaging for a full session, feel different on every run, and let players track and compare their results ?

Key features

Primary features

Random Maze

Generates a new layout and room positions in every run

User has to navigate through the maze to reach the rooms in a certain order

A player has to overcome certain challenges to enter a room.

In each room a player has to play a **mini-game**, **upon completion of which they will be added a jigsaw puzzle piece.**

The game ends when the jigsaw puzzle is solved

Rooms / Mini Games

Nine Mini-games

One distinct mini-game per room that requires engaging problem-solving skills, such as:

- Detecting Anagraphs
- Wordle
- Solving mathematical equations
- Memory sequence
- Fast keys and so on

Staged Locks

For every three rooms, users will receive a digit. The combination of these digits will unlock the next three rooms.

Key features

Secondary features

Log in

Users will be able to play by creating an account or even as a guest user

Secure Passwords

User credentials will be saved in an encrypted file

Track Records

Users will be able to track their performance records

Leaderboard

There will be a local leaderboard showing the best records.

Information that will be available in the leaderboard:

- Minimum completion time
- Minimum steps required to complete the maze
- Minimum attempts required to solve the combination locks
- Room / Mini-Game wise best performance of the players

Key features

Mini Games

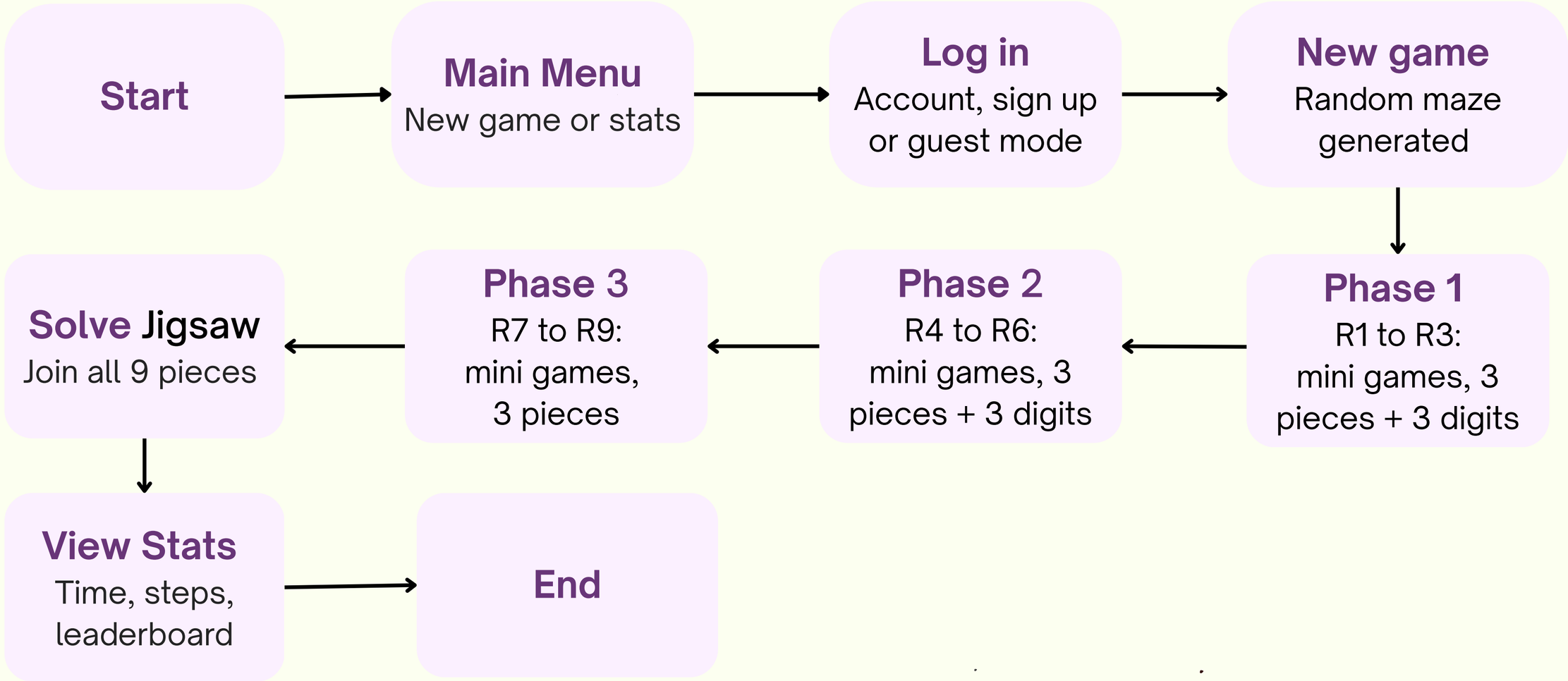


Mini-game: Anagram



Mini-game: 24 game

Core Application Flow



Target Users

Puzzle Enthusiasts

Replayble sessions built around problem solving

Students

A fun way to practise logical thinking

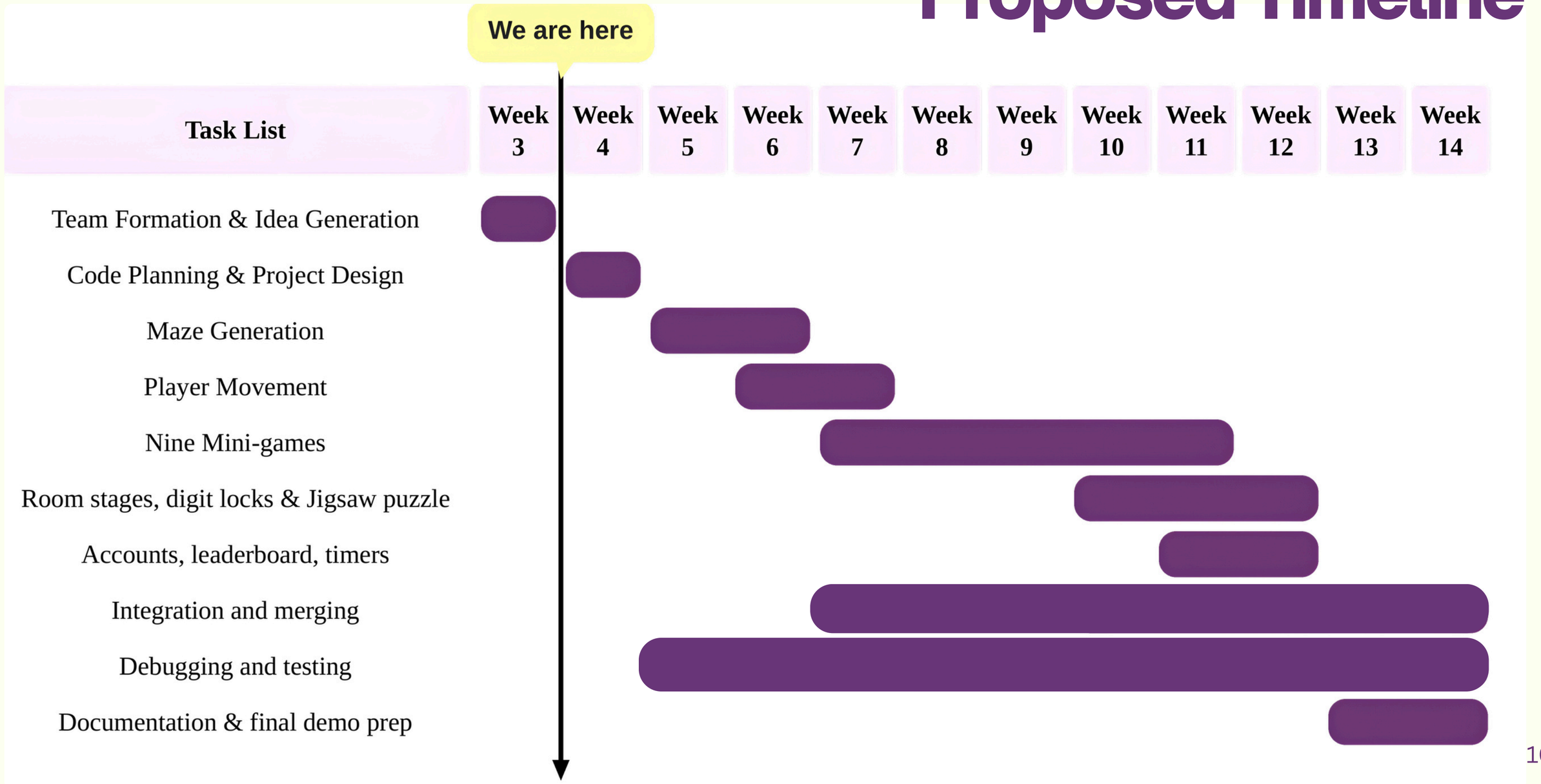
Nostalgic Players

People who know such games or played them as kids

Competitive Players

Leaderboard rankings and per-game records to improve upon

Proposed Timeline



Tools & Technologies

IDE



Version Control



git



Programming Language



Thank You